



Rush em n00bs

The blitzkrieg of the gaming world, this is a strategy that involves barging in on your opponent with all your forces



and allies. An “all-in” in terms of RTS games, this is a very risky manoeuvre which can result in your untimely death if not handled correctly. It is the equivalent of putting all your eggs into one basket and throwing it at an enemy’s head in the hopes of killing him! You will end up with smashed eggs, but with enough eggs in the basket, you just might end up killing him! Shock and awe. Overwhelm and destroy..



BYOC

Popularly known as LAN Parties, the Bring Your Own Comp culture sees a large number of gaming geeks converge on a venue with their own gaming gear for extended sessions of multiplayer gaming. Gaming



enthusiasts bring portable machines, huge custom rigs and gaming peripherals. The trends has become so popular that case manufacturers have even come up with easy carrying handles and grips on their cases; even locks to protect precious innards from thieving hands. DreamHack the world’s largest BYOC party had 13,292 machines connected to the LAN. Gamers play, abuse each other, show off their gear, OD on energy drinks, bust their bladders, and don’t sleep for days on end. Ahh youth gone wild.



Kojima, Hideo

When this man says he’s making an announcement, the whole gaming world comes to a standstill. Why? Quite simply Hideo Kojima was the force behind the immensely popular Metal Gear series. As a game director he has been featured at the top of several “influential people of gaming” lists throughout his career. He has even received two Lifetime Achievement awards for his contribution to gaming. Kojima’s focus on stealth and the art of storytelling in games is what sets him apart. He’s legendary for his use of multiple-camera angles in cut scenes, non-linear story lines, and of course having a very strong story that immerses the gamer ever so completely.



Y do we game?

The question is almost as important as Y we couldn’t come up with a proper topic to write under Y. But that apart, this in itself is worth pondering about. With gaming becoming so addictive over the years, the day won’t be far when we’d require support groups like Gamer’s Anonymous to be formed. Y do we have this compulsion to kick ass? Y this proclivity for exploring virtual playgrounds? The answers lie deep rooted in the human psyche. Some play to overcome challenges. Some play to feel like god. Some like to compete, while some are psychotic and if not given this outlet they’d probably end up chainsawing their families. So you see gaming serves a social purpose too.



Meier, Sid

If strategy and particularly 4x (explore, expand, exploit, and exterminate) is what helps you get your game on, Sid Meier is your god. Among other titles, he’s the creator of Railroad Tycoon and the immensely popular Civilization series. Apart from strategy Sid has several Flight Simulation games to his credit at the very outset of his career. Currently he is the Director of Creative Development at Firaxis, his own company and continues to be a guiding light to budding gamers everywhere.



Unreal Engine

An important milestone in the evolution of gaming, the Unreal Engine forever changed the way games – most notably first person shooters – would look. The Engine was used to create America’s Army, an ultra-realistic shooting simulation / recruiting tool used by the military. What other proof can there be of the realism offered by games developed in the Unreal Engine? And yet the best feature of this engine is it’s omnipresent portability. It runs on virtually all conceivable platforms including Linux, Mac, Flash Player and Android. Some titles to quietly implement the Unreal Engine include games as diverse as *BioShock*, *Gears of War 2*, and *Batman: Arkham Asylum*.



33.6 per cent

The share of Strategy games in the total number of game units sold in the United States. Quite unexpected isn't it? One would've easily assumed it would be first person shooters to dominate, and yet FPS comes a distant second with 9.7%.